

THE CENTURY'S GAP: THE ADVANCEMENT OF ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE AND THE INERTIA OF SOCIAL DEBATE

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Abstract:

This article analyzes the gap between the accelerating advancement of Artificial Intelligence (AI) and the slow pace of the social, ethical, and regulatory debates that should accompany it. It examines the impact of automation on the labor market, the capitalist logic driving the replacement of human workers by artificial systems, and the risks of deepening socioeconomic inequalities. The article argues that AI holds disruptive potential equivalent to that of the Industrial Revolution, and that only through active debate and state intervention will it be possible to ensure that technology serves human well-being.

Keywords: Artificial Intelligence. Ethics. Automation. Labor market. Social inequality.

1 INTRODUCTION

Artificial Intelligence (AI) undeniably represents one of the greatest revolutions in human history. However, the true challenge posed by this innovation is not of a technological nature, but rather a social and ethical one. A dangerous gap can be observed in contemporary society: while technology advances at an exponential pace, social and regulatory debates lag far behind. As a result, society finds itself unprepared to confront the profound ethical questions and structural impacts that the use of these tools is already beginning to trigger.

2 DEVELOPMENT

2.1 Business Ethics and the Labor Market

In this context, the absence of a consolidated ethical debate opens alarming precedents, particularly within the labor market. Automation, driven by strictly capitalist logics, replaces individuals with machines in pursuit of profit maximization, since artificial systems require no vacation time, year-end bonuses, or sick leave. Faced with this reality, a

fundamental question arises about what business ethics means in a scenario where the replacement of human labor generates mass structural unemployment. Technology advances without any consensus on the protection of workers' dignity and livelihoods.

2.2 Social and Urban Impacts

Furthermore, the consequences of this delay in social discussions extend well beyond the corporate world and directly affect the urban landscape and demographics. The lack of preparedness on the part of the State and civil society to retrain and support the population tends to deepen socioeconomic divides. Those with less access to formal education will be the first to be excluded from this new digital era, which may result in the deterioration of living conditions and a significant increase in the population of suburbs, outskirts, and favelas. This represents a cycle of marginalization amplified by the failure to debate and anticipate the harms of technological progress.

3 FINAL REMARKS

Therefore, it is urgent that Artificial Intelligence cease to be treated in a trivial manner or seen merely as everyday entertainment. The current digital revolution holds the same disruptive potential as the Industrial Revolution and demands that ethical, political, and social discussions be accelerated to keep pace with the speed of innovation. Only through active debate and state intervention will it be possible to mitigate social despair, ensuring that technology serves human well-being rather than leading to its exclusion and ruin.

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